

English in my home – Someone on the phone

Unit 2f – The teacher's phone call



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Video

Introduction

This resource has been produced in two different formats:

- a self-access resource for learners with online activities
- this teacher's pack, including teacher's notes and worksheets to download

Overview

This resource, ***Someone on the phone – The teacher's phone call***, is part of Unit 2 of *English in my home*, which aims to give ESOL learners the confidence and the language to deal with situations they may encounter in their homes.

There are three units of ***English in my home***:

Unit 1 Someone at the door aims to give learners confidence and equip them with the language necessary to deal with situations where unexpected callers (e.g. an electricity meter reader) arrive at the door.

Unit 2 Someone on the phone shows how to deal with incoming phone calls from a range of people. This includes unwanted calls (e.g. marketing cold calls).

Unit 3 Something in the post features some common types of mail that people receive (e.g. a utility bill), and enables learners to understand what the text means, and to know what to do in response.

Level: Entry 2 / Access 3 in Scotland / CEF A2. The materials are designed to be flexible in terms of differentiation, and are accessible to established E2 learners and at the same time relevant to E1, as, well as E3 and L1.

Structure, learning hours and delivery context

English in my home provides a minimum of 15 hours of learning in a classroom or self-access context through a series of three linked units. Each unit can be taught as a standalone. Here is an overview of the content of each unit. Each unit has several topics:

Unit 1: Someone at the door (includes films)

- Topic a: Electricity meter reading
- Topic b: Charity collection
- Topic c: Parcel delivery
- Topic d: The neighbour
- Topic e: The noisy television
- Topic f: The teacher's visit

Unit 2: Someone on the phone (includes films)

- Topic a: Cold call
- Topic b: Wrong number
- Topic c: An emergency
- Topic d: Getting a plumber
- Topic e: Changing an appointment
- Topic f: The teacher's phone call

Unit 3: Something in the post

- Topic a: Bank statement
- Topic b: Phone bill
- Topic c: Attempted delivery note
- Topic d: Note from a neighbour

Each of the six topics in *Someone at the door* and *Someone on the phone* features a short film. These films have been scripted specifically for the project, and involve actors. The two central characters are a married Indian couple, who have recently moved to the UK, and who are getting used to life here. Each film focuses on them in a specific scenario, such as dealing with a meter reader who arrives at their flat, or dealing with unwanted cold calls on the telephone. ESOL learners should be able to relate to the experiences of the couple.

The learner materials and teacher notes contain activities for use before, during and after watching the films. They enable the learners to notice, learn and use some of the functional language featured in the films.

Something in the post, uses semi-authentic material of the kinds that learners may receive in their home, and helps them to understand these and know what action is needed.

Most topics provide approximately 60 minutes of classroom time. Units 1 and 2 can last longer if teachers choose to use the transcripts, for example by getting the learners to act out sections of the dialogues.

Unit 2 Someone on the phone: overview

The unit provides at least 6 hours of classroom time, and covers 6 topics. Each topic features a short film, commissioned by the British Council for the ESOL Nexus project, and filmed with professional actors. The films aim to show real-life situations in which ESOL learners may find themselves, and the accompanying classroom and self-study materials aim to give learners the language they need to deal with a range of household situations.

The 6 topics of *Someone on the phone* are called *Cold call*, *Wrong number*, *An emergency*, *Getting a plumber*, *Changing an appointment* and *The teacher's phone call* and can be used in any order.

The teacher's phone call – teacher's notes

Time:

Approximately 2 hours. Timings are flexible and it could take considerably longer than this.

Aims

To enable learners to communicate more confidently with their children's teachers

Objectives

Learners will:

- understand the gist and detail of the film
- learn and speak using some vocabulary from the film
- practise making suggestions orally and in writing

Preparation

- **You will need:** An interactive whiteboard or data projector to show the film 'The teacher's phone call' or computers for each learner/pair of learners, with headphones or audio speakers.
- related self-access activities for learners can be found at:
<http://esol.britishcouncil.org/english-my-home/teachers-phone-call>
- Learner handouts (pages 12 - 16)
- Teacher resources (page 17) for Task 6. Copy and cut up enough problems and suggestions cards for each pair of learners. Keep the problems and suggestions separate.
- If internet access/computers are not available, you will need to prepare your own audio recordings using the transcripts provided (Pages 18 - 20).
- 'The teacher's phone call' Powerpoint which contains links to the interactive games.

A note about interactive whiteboards (IWBs):

Interactive activities are available to support this resource. We have provided links to each individual activity in the teachers' notes (these activities are also available to learners as self-access items). On some interactive whiteboards (not all), the activities will be fully functional (i.e. you will be able to touch the screen to drag and drop, and so on). Links for interactive whiteboards appear in boxes throughout the resource. As part of your preparation before the session you may wish to bookmark the activities you plan to use.

Suggested Procedure

Task 1: Before you watch (Powerpoint slide 1)

- Tell learners that they are going to watch a film, and that first they are going to see some images from it.
- Give out Handout 1, folded so that learners can only see the pictures. Alternatively show Slide 1 of the Powerpoint. Ask learners to discuss the two questions in pairs or groups. During feedback, elicit their ideas about the film, but don't confirm anything at this stage. Encourage learners to be creative with suggestions. If they have seen previous films in the series, elicit the names of Arjun and Sunita, and of Deepak their son. If not, tell them the names of the characters – but don't tell them who the teacher is.

First viewing: gist listening task (slides 2 and 3)

- Write the following four gist questions on the board or show slide 2. Tell learners they are going to watch the film and answer the questions. Give them time to read and understand the questions and check they understand *silly* and *worried*.
 1. *What does Sunita want Arjun to do?*
 2. *Who phones Sunita? Why?*
 3. *Why is Sunita worried?*
 4. *Why is Arjun wearing silly glasses?*
- Play the film 'The teacher's phone call'. Then ask learners to discuss their answers in pairs or groups. Elicit the answers.
- Show slide 3 for a link to an interactive version of the activity. This could be used to review the correct answers.

<http://gamedata.bcdev.org.uk/p/MTYzMTY=>

Task 2: Vocabulary from the film (slides 4, 5, 6, and 7)

- Write the following words on the board, or show slide 4.

noticed worried optician angry silly surprised
pick up whiteboard positive

- Ask learners to discuss in groups if they heard the words used in the film, and if they know who used them and how.
- Monitor the learners' discussions to find out how much knowledge they have, but you don't need to feedback on this task.
- Ask learners to unfold the handout to look at Task 2 and/or show slide 5. Tell them to complete Task 2 in pairs. If learners have good reading and dictionary skills you could give them an English – English dictionary to help. Early finishers could put the paper away and practise spelling the words.
- Elicit feedback. Check all learners understand the words, and drill words to practise pronunciation and word stress. You can use slide 6 for this.
- Alternatively use slide 7 for a link to an interactive version of the activity. This could be used to review the correct answers.

<http://gamedata.bcdev.org.uk/p/MTYxOTM=>

Task 3: Watch the film again (slides 8, 9, 10 and 11)

- Give out Handout 2 folded so that learners can only see the sentences (not the jumbled phrases at the bottom of the handout) and/or show slide 8. Tell them to read the sentences in pairs, and try to complete the sentences (orally) from what they remember from the film. Reassure them that they will see the film again if they can't remember or didn't understand.
- Don't feed back on this task, but play the film again and ask learners to listen for the missing information. They can make notes if they wish but they don't need to write anything if they prefer.
- When the film is finished get them to discuss their answers again in their pairs or groups. Then let them unfold the paper and write the answers in the gaps. You can use slide 9 to demonstrate this task. Stronger learners could write the answers without unfolding the paper.
- You can feedback on this task using slide 10 if you wish.
- Alternatively, on slide 11, click on the link for an interactive version of the task. You could encourage learners to come to the computer or board to choose or review the correct answers:

<http://gamedata.bcdev.org.uk/p/MTY0OTg=>

- A possible extension activity would be to write the words from Task 2 on the board again (or show slide 3 again) and get learners to use the words to tell the story of the film again in groups.

Task 4: Language focus: Making suggestions (Slides 12, 13, 14, 15 and 16)

- Give out Handout 3 and ask learners to look at Task 4 or show slide 12. Tell them to look at the sentences and try to fill in the missing words. You can tell them that they only need three different words. Elicit the answers. Then get learners to decide in their pairs who said each sentence, and who the person said it to. Do the first question with the whole group as an example.
- In feedback, write the sentences on the board, or show slide 13. Click the mouse to reveal who spoke. Then ask learners to discuss how the sentences are different.
- Elicit that two of the sentences are statements and two are questions. Ask 'How is the meaning different?' Try to elicit that the questions are requests and the statements are suggestions and check that learners understand the difference. (Suggestions are a more polite way of getting someone to do something.) Elicit that 'could' is more polite than 'can'.
- To consolidate the learners' understanding of requests and suggestions, show slide 14 or play the interactive task as a class on slide 15.

<http://gamedata.bcdev.org.uk/p/MTY1MDE=>

- During feedback highlight the following:
 - The teacher makes suggestions not requests, because she is being polite and careful. She doesn't want to tell Sunita what to do.
 - For suggestions we can say:
 - *You could...*
 - *Maybe you could / can...*
 - *Perhaps you could / can...*
 - *Perhaps* and *maybe* have exactly the same meaning.

Task 5: More practice making suggestions and requests (Slides 16, 17, 18 and 19)

- Tell learners to look at Task 5 or show slide 16. Ask them to decide if the sentences are suggestions or requests. Encourage learners to work on their own before they check their answers in pairs.
- During feedback you could write the answers in two columns on the board or show slide 17.
- Alternatively, show the slide 18 and complete the interactive task as a group.

<http://gamedata.bcdev.org.uk/p/MTY1MDM=>

- Rub out some of the words from Task 5 on the board, or show slide 19 and get learners to repeat the suggestion sentences. Try to insist on polite intonation. You can also focus on the sentence stress and pronunciation of *could*. In each of these sentences the main verb (eg *get*, *sit*) is stressed and *could* is usually unstressed, so is pronounced /kəd/. Drill the sentences chorally and individually, and then get learners to practise saying them to each other in pairs.

Task 6: Problems and suggestions (Slides 20, 21 and 22)

- Tell learners they are going to read some problems and practise making polite suggestions.
- Demonstrate the task by reading out one problem or showing slide 20. Tell them it's your problem, so they are giving you advice. Get them to discuss the problem in pairs or groups and then elicit suggestions, encouraging learners to use the language they have learnt: *Maybe/Perhaps you could....* Encourage them to expand their answers and make more than one suggestion.
- Give out the cut up cards (problem cards only) from Teacher Resources page 17, one set for each group of 2 or 3 learners. Ask learners to pick up one card in turn, tell the problem to their partner (as if it is their own problem). Their partner(s) should then make suggestions, making two or three suggestions for each problem. Monitor to note errors and/or good examples of use of suggestion language.
- In feedback you could introduce a class discussion of the problem that caused the most interest.
- Then write common errors noted during monitoring on the board for learners to correct. Or you could write two or three sentences on the board, where at least one of which is correct, and get learners to identify the errors/correct sentence(s).
- Then tell learners they are going to read some suggestions for the problems they've just been discussing. Give out the suggestion cards from the Teacher Resources page 17 and tell learners to match the suggestions with the problems. Monitor to check they are

doing this correctly. You could ask early finishers to say if they agree or disagree with the suggestions given. Early finishers could also go and check the work of other groups once you have checked their work.

- Give out Handout 4, and ask learners to read and match the problems and suggestions again, to reinforce their understanding. You can use slide 21 to demonstrate this task.
- Feedback on the answers (using slide 22 if you wish) and highlight any problems in understanding that you noticed during monitoring. Tell learners to underline the suggestion sentences in the texts.

Task 7: Writing suggestions (Slides 23 and 24)

- Give out Handout 5 and ask learners to read the three problems in Task 7 and/or show slide 23. Tell learners to read the problems and then discuss them in their groups.
- Then ask each group of 2 or 3 learners to work together and write their suggestions. You could use mini-whiteboards for this, or if you don't have mini whiteboards you could give each group a blank sheet of paper to write on. If appropriate you could give the pen to the weakest learner in each group, and tell the others they have to help that learner but are not allowed to touch the pen.
- As they finish, tell the learners to swap suggestions and read each other's work. Put all the suggestions on one wall or table. Ask them to discuss these questions (slide 24):
 1. Which problem are the suggestions about?
 2. Do you agree with the suggestions?
 3. Which is the best suggestion?
 4. Are the suggestion sentences good?

Task 8: Cooler - Tell 'The teacher's phone call' story again (slide 25)

- If you have some time left, you could show slide 25, or write these words on the board:
pick up, coffee, whiteboard, glasses, worried, positive, TV, optician, picked up, silly
- Put learners in pairs and ask them to retell the story of the film using the words in slide 25 (with the focus on communication rather than accuracy). Alternatively you could use this activity at the beginning of your next lesson to recap.
- Refer learners to the online versions of these ESOL Nexus activities about *The teacher's phone call*: <http://esol.britishcouncil.org/english-my-home/teachers-phone-call>

Handout 1

Task 1: Before you watch

- Who are these people?
- What are they doing? Why?

1



2



3



4



Task 2: Vocabulary from the film

Here are some words you heard in the film. Put one in each gap.

noticed worried optician angry surprised
pick up whiteboard positive silly

1. In the classroom the teacher writes on the
2. If you have a problem with your eyes you can go to an
3. The teacher that Deepak had a problem with his eyes. She saw it.
4. It's late at night and your daughter hasn't come home. You feel
5. Arjun ordered some glasses. One week later he went to the optician to the glasses.
6. You ask your child three times to go to bed, but he doesn't go. You feel
7. Usually my husband never buys me a present, but today he bought me some flowers. I was
8. Arjun's glasses look Other people will laugh at them.
9. Arjun wants Deepak to feel about wearing glasses. He wants him to feel good.

Handout 2

Task 3: Watch the film again

Watch the film again. What are the missing words.

1. Sunita asks Arjun to pick up
2. She also asks him to buy some
3. The teacher noticed that Deepak can't
4. She thinks Deepak needs
5. Some children don't want to wear glasses. They are worried that
6. Deepak needs to feel positive about
7. Arjun noticed that Deepak often sits
8. Last week he took Deepak to the
9. Today he went to the optician and
10. When Arjun wears his glasses Deepak wants

see the whiteboard	picked up the glasses	to wear his glasses too
glasses	other children will laugh	wearing glasses
close to the TV	optician	coffee
Deepak from school		

Handout 3

Task 4: Making requests and suggestions

Here are some sentences from the film.

Fill in the missing words.

Who says each sentence? Who is he/she speaking to?

1. go and get him?
2. We don't have any coffee. Maybe pick some up.
3. tell him that there's nothing wrong with wearing glasses.
4. go to the toilet now please?

Now look at the sentences again. How are they different?

*Which sentences are **requests**: asking someone to do something?*

*Which sentences are **suggestions**: saying it's a good idea to do something?*

What is the difference between the requests and the suggestions?

Task 5: More practice making requests and suggestions

Now look at these sentences. Which ones are requests and which are suggestions? Write them again in the correct column.

- | | |
|--|---|
| 1. Could you put your toys away please, Deepak? | 2. Maybe you could go and see an optician. |
| 3. Please could you help Deepak with his homework? | 4. Perhaps you can sit down and talk to Deepak. |
| 5. We could talk to Deepak's teacher. | 6. Can you switch off your computer please? |

Requests	Suggestions

Handout 4

Task 6: Problems and suggestions

Match the problem and the suggestion.

Problem	Suggestion
1. My son doesn't want to go to school in the mornings. He says he has a stomach ache but I know he isn't sick.	a. Perhaps you could try to learn one new word every day. You could get a special book, and write the words in it. At the end of every week maybe you could test yourself on all the words you learnt that week.
2. My sister often borrows money from me and she never gives it back.	b. I think maybe you should stop practising with her. She will not learn when she is stressed. Perhaps you could find a book she really likes and read it to her. When she starts to enjoy books again, then she will learn to read.
3. My daughter is having problems with her reading. I practise with her every day, but she is getting stressed and she can't read very easy words.	c. Maybe you could talk to his teacher. You could ask her if he is happy at school, or if she has noticed a problem with him.
4. I find English spelling very difficult. I can never remember how to spell words.	d. Yes, girls can be very difficult at that age. Maybe you could take her on a trip to a place she will really like. Then if she relaxes and enjoys herself you could take her for a coffee or a nice meal and say how good it is to see her smiling.
5. My teenage daughter seems to be very unhappy, but she doesn't talk about it. If I ask her what is wrong she gets angry.	e. Perhaps you could sit down and have a chat with her. You could ask her what she wants the money for and why she doesn't have enough money. Maybe you could say you will not lend her any more money if she doesn't pay back the money she borrowed before.

Handout 5

Task 7: Writing suggestions

Now you write suggestions for these problems.

Problem	Suggestion
1. I want to go to college but I can't find any childcare for my daughter.	
2. I don't like my son's friends. They are very rude and they drink alcohol on the street. I think they sometimes steal from shops. I am worried about my son.	
3. My daughter is putting on a lot of weight. I try to cook healthy food but she always buys crisps and chocolate to eat between meals.	

Teacher resources

Task 6 - version to cut up ✂

Problem	Suggestion
1. My son doesn't want to go to school in the mornings. He says he has a stomach ache but I know he isn't sick.	a. Perhaps you could try to learn one new word every day. You could get a special book, and write the words in it. At the end of every week maybe you could test yourself on all the words you learnt that week.
2. My sister often borrows money from me and she never gives it back.	b. I think maybe you should stop practising with her. She will not learn when she is stressed. Perhaps you could find a book she really likes and read it to her. When she starts to enjoy books again, then she will learn to read.
3. My daughter is having problems with her reading. I practise with her every day, but she is getting stressed and she can't read very easy words.	c. Maybe you could talk to his teacher. You could ask her if he is happy at school, or if she has noticed a problem with him.
4. I find English spelling very difficult. I can never remember how to spell words.	d. Yes, girls can be very difficult at that age. Maybe you could take her on a trip to a place she will really like. Then if she relaxes and enjoys herself you could take her for a coffee or a nice meal and say how good it is to see her smiling.
5. My teenage daughter seems to be very unhappy, but she doesn't talk about it. If I ask her what is wrong she gets angry.	e. Perhaps you could sit down and have a chat with her. You could ask her what she wants the money for and why she doesn't have enough money. Maybe you could say you will not lend her any more money if she doesn't pay back the money she borrowed before.

Transcript

Sunita Arjun! It's three o'clock!

Arjun Yeah... So?

Sunita So, we need to pick up Deepak from school.

Arjun Oh. Could you go and get him? I'm busy!

Sunita What do you mean, you're busy?

Arjun Just doing some work.

Sunita I think it might be better if you switch it on first! So you're busy, you can't go and pick up Deepak from school, and you're working? Wow!

Arjun Actually, I've just finished. Oh look... it's three o'clock, time to go and get Deepak from school. I'll go and get him.

Sunita Oh, that's so kind of you, thank you! Oh... we don't have any coffee. Maybe you can pick some up, when you're in town?

Arjun Yeah, OK. I'll take Deepak into town with me. We need to get a few things too.

(The phone rings)

Sunita Hello?

Teacher Hello, Mrs Chowdry?

Sunita Speaking.

Teacher Oh, hello Mrs Chowdry. It's Mrs Palmer here. Deepak's school teacher.

Sunita Oh yes, hello. Is everything OK? My husband has gone to collect Deepak from school. He's not late is he?

Teacher No, no, everything's fine. And his reading's getting much better now. But I didn't have time to speak with your husband today.

Sunita Oh, what about?

Teacher Well, it's just that today, in class, Deepak said he couldn't see the whiteboard very well.

Sunita Oh...

Teacher At home, does he have problems seeing things? Like the TV or anything?

Sunita Oh I don't know.

English in my home - Someone on the phone – The teacher's phone call

- Teacher Or....
- Sunita I've never noticed.
- Teacher Well, I was thinking. Perhaps he needs glasses.
- Sunita Glasses?
- Teacher Yeah. But, the thing is, sometimes it's difficult to talk about this with children. Some children, you know, they just don't want to wear glasses, they're worried that they'll look silly, or that the other children will laugh.
- Sunita I see.
- Teacher So, perhaps if you found a good time to sit down with Deepak and talk about it with him. You could explain it, you know, tell him that there's nothing wrong with wearing glasses.
- Sunita Right.
- Teacher And then maybe go and see an optician, get an eye test for him.
- Sunita I see.
- Teacher It's important for him to understand why glasses can be good for him. He needs to feel positive about it, you know, feel good about the glasses.
- Sunita Oh. OK, well, I'll talk with my husband about it this evening.
- Teacher Ok, well, I hope that's helpful. I just wanted to tell you.
- Sunita Yes, well, thank you very much.
- Teacher OK, Mrs Chowdry. Bye.
- Sunita Bye. So Deepak needs glasses!
-
- Arjun OK Deepak, can you go to the toilet now please? And remember to wash your hands.
- Sunita Hi.
- Arjun Hi there.
- Sunita Deepak's teacher phoned.
- Arjun Oh?
- Sunita But we'll talk about it later. When Deepak's gone to sleep.
- Arjun OK. Expensive day today! I hope you won't be angry with me!

English in my home - Someone on the phone – The teacher's phone call

- Sunita Why?
- Arjun Well, I noticed that Deepak sometimes doesn't see very well. Like, he often sits very close to the TV.
- Sunita You noticed?! Arjun!
- Arjun Yes, so I took him to the optician's last week. And he had an eye test.
- Sunita You did?
- Arjun Yes. Didn't I tell you that?
- Sunita No! I'm just, surprised, that's all!
- Arjun Anyway, so.... I got him some glasses. And we picked them up today.
- Sunita Oh!
- Arjun But you know, it's important for him to feel good about his glasses, about wearing them.
- Sunita Arjun, did you talk to Deepak's teacher?
- Arjun What? No? Why?
- Sunita No, I'm just wondering. Yes, I mean I know that's true. But how are you going to get him to feel good about wearing glasses? That's very difficult....
- Arjun What?! No, it's easy. I'm showing him that glasses can be fun. Look...
- Sunita Sometimes, I think *you* are the 6-year-old!
- Arjun Well, why not? When I wear these glasses, Deepak wants to wear his glasses too!
- Sunita You know what, sometimes, you can be a really really good dad!
- Arjun 'Sometimes'? What do you mean 'sometimes'? Deepak! Come and show mummy your glasses. I'm wearing mine!

Unit 2f Someone on the phone: The teacher's phone call – answers**Gist listening task**

1. Sunita wants Arjun to pick up their son, Deepak, from school.
2. The teacher rings Sunita because Deepak can't see the whiteboard at school.
3. Because the teacher thinks Deepak needs glasses.
4. Arjun wants to make him feel good about wearing glasses.

Task 2: Vocabulary from the film

1. whiteboard
2. optician
3. noticed
4. worried
5. pick up
6. angry
7. surprised
8. silly
9. positive

Task 3: Watch the film again

1. Deepak from school
2. coffee
3. see the whiteboard
4. glasses
5. other children will laugh
6. wearing glasses
7. close to the tv
8. optician
9. picked up the glasses
10. to wear his glasses too

Task 4: Making suggestions

- | | |
|--------------|-------------------|
| 1. Could you | Sunita to Arjun |
| 2. you can | Sunita to Arjun |
| 3. you could | Teacher to Sunita |
| 4. Can you | Arjun to Deepak |

Task 5: Problems and suggestions

- | | |
|------|------------|
| 1. c | Request |
| 2. e | Suggestion |
| 3. b | Suggestion |
| 4. a | Suggestion |
| 5. d | Request |

'Someone on the phone – 2f – 'The teacher's phone call' video

The video that accompanies the activities for Unit 1 'Someone on the phone – The teacher's phone call' is available to watch on the ESOL Nexus website.

